

Creeper Virus

In 1971, Creeper Virus was the first experimental virus which affected DEC PDP-10 systems running the TENEX operating system

Stuxnet

It is the first programmable logic controller rootkit malware whose target was industrial software and equipment

Shield your PC

With your system facing threats from all endpoints, it is only wise to invest in a complete security solution. We guide you through a maze of 17 security suites to tell you where you should invest.

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Back in the day when the internet was just about taking its baby steps in India, we did not care much about security. That was mainly due to the fact that very few of us were actually 'connected' and security solutions were quite expensive. Cut to today, when India ranks third in terms of Internet user base globally, with over 100 million internet users, the landscape has changed dramatically.

Securing your PC is the first thing that you do after assembling and installing of software is done. Apart from viruses there are trojans, worms, adwares, rootkits that can inversely affect your system, without you even knowing about it. At other times, there are malicious scripts that do not really infect your PC, but will cause wierd behaviour such as slowing down of performance, random rebooting, services not running when they ought to, etc.

Merely using an anti-virus today is like partly securing your system. This is where complete security suites step in.

They comprise an anti-virus; anti-spyware; internet protection from phishing, spam and malicious links and PC tuning utilities. Some suites even incorporate parental controls while others provide data backup plans, either locally or on the cloud.

We decided to pit 17 security suites available in the market against each other to find the best solution for your needs.

Features

All the suites we tested had an anti-virus, an anti-spyware, internet protection and a firewall. The differentiator came in the form of additional features like parental control and data backup that separates the various suites.

In Norton 360, the Norton Reputation Scan analyses a particular application or file and creates the application reputation. This takes into consideration how long the file has been in existence, how many other Norton users use the file, etc. You can see the summary of individual file or summary graphs.

The Performance menu in Norton 360 gives a graphical representation of your CPU and memory usage by the program vis-a-vis the system.

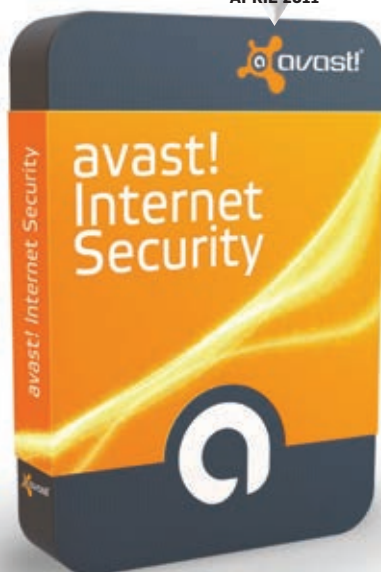
You need to download Norton SafetyMinder software on your PC to activate parental controls. You have to fill in your details along with your family's details. Norton then updates these details in the Norton Online Family server. The Identity Safe feature

allows you to store all your login details on various websites, credit card and debit card details in one place.

Panda Global Protection 2011 supports online data backup option, to allow you to access your data from anywhere, so long as you are connected to the net. Optimise performance allows you to schedule clean-up of your computer to make it more speedy.

eScan Internet Security Suite is one of the rare security suites which has a dock based interface. This interface is quite a fresh approach specially in a category as serious as security suites. It does invite the user to explore more options. Under Endpoint security tab, you can set applications to block or set a password to be entered for using a USB device. You can also whitelist certain USB devices which you use frequently. Web Protection allows you to set filters based on keywords or websites. This was much better than the one found on Panda Global Security. Whitelisting also speeds up the scanning process as the safe softwares will not be rescanned. Another interesting feature is the Remote support, which lets an eScan representative access your system remotely to resolve an issue that is not being solved by you.

Trend Micro Titanium does not have an update button as it automatically updates itself when connected to the internet. This is something we like, as you no longer have to



avast! Internet Security 6 was quick at scanning and occupies limited memory on load